



FADE THE CHALK

POST-MORTEM

Multi-Track · Thursday, June 11, 2026

Six Plays, Five Tracks · The First Losing Day

“First losing day. Still net positive lifetime — and the model learned more tonight than in three winning days combined.”

Final Scorecard

Track / Race	Pick (PP)	ML	Stake	Result	Coll.	Net
Belmont · R7	Bella Knows (4)	7/2	\$186.40	2nd (3-4-2-9)	\$34.90	-\$151.50
Churchill · R3	Sunset Harbour (1)	9/2	\$136.40	3rd (2-7-1-6)	\$0	-\$136.40
Churchill · R5	Absolutely Hot (4)	10-1	\$136.40	5th (7-6-8-3-4)	\$0	-\$136.40
Santa Anita · R7	Hey Lil Lady (5)	8-1	\$186.40	CANCELLED	\$186.40	\$0
Charles Town · R4	Fiber Strong (6)	4-1	\$86.40	3rd (3-2-6-4)	\$0	-\$86.40
Charles Town · R7	Dadio (5)	12-1	\$56.00	DNP (2-9-1-8)	\$0	-\$56.00
TOTAL			\$788.00		\$221.30	-\$566.70

Woodbine R8 removed — the original analysis said to skip it; it was added to the card without full Phase 1–5 analysis.

Race-by-Race Breakdown

Belmont R7 — Right Timing (3) wins, Bella Knows (4) 2nd

Thesis: Favorite (Right Timing) is an E-type in a hot pace (2E + 5E/P). Tagged VULNERABLE via Trigger B. Doubled the stake on Bella Knows, an S-type closer.

What happened: The favorite won anyway. Our closer ran 2nd but couldn't close the 10-point Beyer gap.

Exacta 3-4 hit — \$34.90 collected (\$5 base on a \$6.98 payout per \$1). “Keep the favorite in the exotics” saved us from a zero.

Churchill R3 — Argan (2) wins, Protomagic (7) 2nd, Sunset Harbour (1) 3rd

Thesis: Argan and First Hill duel; Sunset Harbour sits on the rail and inherits.

What happened: The pace duel played out, but Protomagic (PP7, S-type, 121 days off) — a horse our Layoff Filter excluded — rallied into 2nd and blew our exacta. Our box (1, 2, 6, 3) had the winner but missed the 2nd-place finisher.

Churchill R5 — Rose Ruler (7) wins, Gypsy Art (6) 2nd, Double Talker (8) 3rd

Thesis: Nuclear pace (7 horses forward in 5f); Absolutely Hot (P-type) sits behind the carnage and picks up the pieces.

What happened: The top 3 finishers had the top 3 Beyer ceilings in the field (102, 100, 104). The pace didn't collapse — in five furlongs there's only one furlong of stretch. Pressers who sat just off the speed kicked; our stalker never got close (5th).

Key insight: In 5f sprints, pace doesn't collapse like routes. E/P pressers are the sweet spot — “sit just off and kick” beats “come from behind” when there's no room to close.

Charles Town R4 — Boss E Boogs (3) wins, Take Your Time (2) 2nd, Fiber Strong (6) 3rd

Thesis: Six E-type speed horses demolish each other; Fiber Strong (the only non-speed) inherits.

What happened: Boss E Boogs (260 days off) wired it. Take Your Time (147 days off) ran 2nd. Both layoff horses. Our box (6, 7, 1, 4) had 3rd and 4th but missed 1st and 2nd entirely.

Payouts we missed: Trifecta 3-2-6 paid \$349.30. Superfecta 3-2-6-1 paid \$1,179.90. Painful — we had half the key.

Charles Town R7 — Buster the Bully (2) wins, Theycallhimgoldie (9) 2nd

Thesis: All 9 horses are speed. Dadio (the only E/P) has a tactical edge sitting just off.

What happened: Buster the Bully (in our box) won, but Theycallhimgoldie (9, not in box) ran 2nd. Our pick Dadio was nowhere.

Races We Passed — What Would Have Happened

Penn National R3 — PASSED (our pick was the favorite)

Pick: Ready for Trouble (PP1, 5/2 ML). **Why passed:** she's the favorite, and the hard rule is never bet the chalk. **Conviction:** very high — the most extreme pace setup on the card (6 of 8 are E-type; she's the only stalker with form). **Actual finish:** 3-2-6-1 (Cohesive, My Girl Back Home, Pure Bliss, Ready for Trouble).

Bet	Horses	Result	Collected
Win (\$50)	Ready for Trouble (1)	4th — loss	\$0
Exacta Box (\$5)	1, 2, 6, 8	3-2 miss (3 not in box)	\$0
Trifecta Box (\$1)	1, 2, 6, 8	3-2-6 miss (3 not in box)	\$0
Superfecta Box (\$0.10)	1, 2, 6, 8	3-2-6-1 miss (3 not in box)	\$0

Verdict: even if we'd played it, \$0 collected. Cohesive (a 45/1 bomb) won by changing running style mid-race — unpredictable. The “never bet the favorite” rule saved us \$136.40. The payouts that existed were monsters (EX \$539.20, Tri \$5,919.40, Super \$24,725.60), but Cohesive (93 ceiling, E-type in a nuclear pace) had no signal or ceiling justification for the box.

Churchill R7 — PASSED (the favorite is protected)

Pick: Lovin' on the Run (PP2, 6/1 ML). **Why passed:** Five a Side (7/5 fave) is P-style = PROTECTED. The thesis only works when speed is favored; a stalker favorite benefits from the pace duel rather than getting cooked by it. **Actual finish:** 1-4-3-7 (Five a Side, White Rocks, Cat's Cave, Three Coats).

Bet	Horses	Result	Collected
Win (\$50)	Lovin' on the Run (2)	DNP — loss	\$0
Exacta Box (\$5)	2, 1, 6, 4	1-4 hit	\$91.00
Trifecta Box (\$1)	2, 1, 6, 4	1-4-3 miss (3 not in box)	\$0
Superfecta Box (\$0.10)	2, 1, 6, 4	1-4-3-7 miss	\$0

Verdict: the protected favorite won (thesis confirmed — correct not to bet against her), but our exotic box had Five a Side (1) and White Rocks (4), so the **exacta hit at \$91.00**. Under the new rule (“never bet the fave” kills the win bet only): skip the win (\$50 saved), play the exotics (\$86.40), collect \$91 — **net +\$4.60 instead of passing entirely**. This race validates the new rule: decoupling the win from the exotics turns a full pass into a small profit.

Learnings Locked In

New hard rules (added to CLAUDE.md)

Rule	What it does
No bullring tracks	Skip CT, MNR, TDN, DED, EVD, FMT, FL, BTP entirely. Circumference ≤ 1 mile, stretch ≤ 1,050 ft. Our pace thesis has no edge here.
No low-conviction exotics	Don't bet races without full Phase 1–5 analysis. No adding races “on feel.”
“Never bet the fave” = win bet only	The 7/2+ rule kills the WIN bet only. If Phase 1–5 produced a box, play the exotics regardless.

New box construction (replaces the old signal-score method)

Old method	New method — Beyer Ceiling Box
Box = horses that fit the pace thesis	Box = top 4 horses by best Beyer (career high)
Signals/style drove box selection	Signals/style drive the WIN pick; ceiling drives the BOX
Fave included as a special rule	Fave + win pick mandatory; expand to 5 if needed
Excluded horses for layoff/style	Only exclude for a 3+ furlong surface/distance change with no prior race

Why: tonight's results sorted by Beyer ceiling in multiple races. Churchill R5's top 3 finishers were the top 3 ceilings. The stopwatch doesn't care about the narrative.

Strategy refinements

Learning	Applies to	Detail
Trigger B has an elite-connections override	Spot the Vulnerable Favorite	Top-5 jockey + top-5 trainer + 10-pt Beyer edge = fave powers through pace pressure. Downgrade the trigger, don't fire.
Beyer ceiling > setup for WIN picks	All win bets	8+ pt gap between our pick's ceiling and the fave's = reduce stake. Setup gets contention; ceiling determines winning.
5f sprints don't collapse	Pace Makes the Race	Under 5f, prefer E/P pressers over P/S closers for win bets — not enough distance for closers to make up ground.

Learning	Applies to	Detail
Layoff filter fails at bullring sprints	Layoff + No Workouts	4 layoff horses (90–260 days off) hit the board tonight. At 4.5f, fitness barely matters — speed is innate. Moot now (bullrings banned).
Stalker fave = PROTECTED, not vulnerable	Spot the Vulnerable Favorite	Thesis only works when speed is favored. A stalker fave benefits from the duel — don't pass the exotics, just skip the win.
Extreme distance stretch-outs = exclude from box	Beyer Ceiling Box	3+ furlong jump with no prior race at the new distance = unproven. Integrity (4–5f sprints to 8.5f) ran nowhere.
Inside E/P pressers hold for placings	Box consideration	PP1–3 + E/P + turf route = saves ground, hangs on for 3rd/4th. Box candidate.

New Strategies Added to the Model

Based on tonight's results, we added 8 new rules to the Fade the Chalk model. These are now active and will be executed on every future race day.

Hard rules (gates that skip races or modify bets)

1. No Bullring Tracks

Tracks with tiny circumferences (Charles Town, Mountaineer, Thistledown, etc.) are permanently off the card. The whole model is built around pace dynamics — speed horses pressuring each other, closers inheriting when the pace collapses. On a half-mile track with a 660-foot stretch, none of that applies: everyone is speed, there's no room to close, and results are coin flips. We have no edge. Skip.

2. No Low-Conviction Exotics

If we didn't run the full analysis on a race, we don't bet it. Period. Tonight we added Woodbine R8 “on feel” without doing the work — and lost \$186.40 on a race our own analysis told us to skip. Every race gets the full Phase 1–5 treatment or it doesn't get our money.

3. “Never Bet the Fave” = Win Bet Only

The old rule killed entire races when our pick turned out to be the favorite. That's wrong. The win bet still needs value (7/2 or better) — that hasn't changed. But the exotic box is mechanical: it's built on speed figures, not opinions about value. If we did the work and built the box, we play the exotics even when we can't find a value win bet. Tonight this would have turned Churchill R7 from a full pass into a +\$4.60 profit.

4. Beyer Ceiling Gap = Reduce Stake

If the horse we're betting to win has a career-best figure 8 or more points slower than the favorite's career best, we cut the win bet in half. Our horse might run a great 2nd or 3rd (good for exotics) but probably can't outrun a significantly faster horse to the wire. Tonight Bella Knows (83 ceiling) vs. Right Timing (93 ceiling) — a 10-point gap. She ran 2nd exactly as expected. We should have bet \$50, not \$100.

5. Sprint Closer Penalty (5 furlongs or less)

In sprint races, never bet a horse that comes from behind to win. There's only about one furlong of stretch — roughly seven seconds of running — not enough time to close a gap. Instead, bet the pressers: horses that sit just off the speed, save energy, and kick past tired leaders in the short stretch. Tonight in Churchill R5 we bet a stalker in a 5-furlong race. She finished 5th. The top 3 finishers were all pressers.

Box construction (how we pick the 4 horses in our exotic bets)

6. Beyer Ceiling Box

The exotic box is now built on speed, not story. We take the 4 horses with the highest career-best figures in the field. That's it. We used to pick box horses based on who “fit the pace narrative” — closers in speed duels, pressers in route races. But tonight proved the fastest horses hit the board regardless of style, layoff, or storyline. In Churchill R5, the top 3 finishers were the top 3 speed figures. The stopwatch doesn't care about the thesis.

7. Inside E/P Turf Expander

On turf routes, if a presser is drawn on the inside (posts 1–3), add them as a 5th horse in the trifecta and superfecta boxes. These horses save ground on the rail, draft behind leaders, use less energy, and hold for 3rd or 4th at a high rate. They won't win — but they complete exotic tickets. Tonight Abigail (post 2, presser) held 3rd in Belmont R7. If she'd been our 5th horse, we cash a trifecta instead of missing it.

Vulnerability refinement (when we double down against the favorite)

8. Elite Connections Override

When we identify a vulnerable favorite (speed horse in a pace duel), we normally double the win stake. But if that favorite also has the best jockey at the meet, the best trainer at the meet, AND a figure 8+ points higher than our horse — don't double. Still bet against them (the vulnerability is real) but keep the stake standard. Horses that talented power through bad situations that would sink average runners. Tonight Right Timing (Prat + Chad Brown + 93 Beyer) won through a pace duel we correctly identified as trouble. She was just too good for it to matter.

Night Summary

Record: 0-for-5 win bets (plus 1 refund and 1 cancellation). **Exotics:** 1 exacta hit (Belmont R7, 3-4, \$34.90). **P/L:** −\$566.70 on \$788 wagered (−71.9% ROI).

What went right: “keep the favorite in the exotics” confirmed again (the fave hit the board in 4 of 5 races); directional reads were often correct (closers contended, speed dueled); dropped races were correctly dropped (Penn National's fave ran 4th, Churchill R7's fave won).

What went wrong: box construction missed winners in every race — thesis-based boxes excluded live horses; the layoff filter was backwards at short distances (4 layoff horses hit the board); bullring races offered no edge (all speed, no dynamics); the “exotics only” tier was gambling without conviction (Woodbine added on feel).

Structural changes made tonight: the Beyer Ceiling Box replaces thesis-based box construction; bullring tracks permanently banned; “never bet the fave” decoupled from the exotics; low-conviction exotics banned (full analysis or no action).

Lifetime Record (updated)

Date	Track	Races	W-L	Wagered	Coll.	P/L	ROI
2026-05-24	Churchill Downs	6 (R5–R10)	2-4	\$554	\$611.40	+\$57.40	+10.4%
2026-06-06	Saratoga (Belmont Day)	12 (1 skip)	3-9	\$1,564	\$2,434	+\$870	+56%
2026-06-07	Saratoga	6 (R6–R11)	2-4	\$904	\$1,339.75	+\$435.75	+48%
2026-06-11	Multi-track	5 (1 cxl)	0-5	\$788	\$221.30	−\$566.70	−71.9%
TOTAL		29	7-22	\$3,810	\$4,606.45	+\$796.45	+20.9%

First losing day. Still net positive lifetime. The model learned more tonight than in three winning days combined.